Chapter 19

A takinima – The woven bamboo wall

Enoch Horai Magum

Figure 1: *A inu gorogorohu* – A sleeping house

(1)	*A takinima eve a peha taba to tab-otaboo vai niara nomanai en Teapu.*	Plaited bamboo is a thing that we use today for making walls here in the Teop region.
(2)	*Eve he na paku raara bona koopu.*	We make it from *koopu* bamboos.
(3)	*A kiu nae he na paku vonaen:*	The work on it is done as follows:

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(4)	*Eara na tagihu rara rasuu*	We go into the jungle
(5)	*ei kou a koopu sa teitei vira bata haana kasuana.*	because there are not many *koopu* bamboos along the coast.
(6)	*A koopu vai a mataa ae bebeahu na teitei nana rasuu.*	The good and long *koopu* bamboos grow in the jungle.
(7)	*Beara tagihu ei to sun nae a koopu,*	When we go into the jungle where the *koopu* bamboos stand,
(8)	*eara toro siisira rakaha roho a koopu, eara repaa mosi mana.*	we must intensively examine the *koopu* bamboos, before we eventually cut them.
(9)	*O koopu toro mosi ara toro manoto bara toro mahaka rakaha mee.*	The *koopu* bamboo that we should cut must be mature and also must be very dry.
(10)	*Eara sa antee haara tea mosi o koopu vai o kobus,*	We cannot cut the moist *koopu* bamboo,
(11)	*tabae na antee nana tea koava ge mahamahan,*	because it can rot or leave spaces,
(12)	*beara takinima nie,*	when we weave the bamboo wall with it,
(13)	*ei be raka bata maa a koopu.*	that is when the *koopu* bamboos dry up.
(14)	*Beara sisira vakavara, eara repaa mosi.*	When we have finished examining (them), we cut (them).

(a) (b) (c)

Figure 2: (a) *A dee koopu* – A load of bamboos, (b) *Kopakopaa koopu* – Cut bamboos lengthwise, (c) *O komano koopu* – The inside of the (shaved) bamboos

(15) *Are mosi vaantee a inu, eara repaa paku amaa dee.*
Then we cut as many as are needed for the house, and then we make loads (to carry the *koopu* bamboos home).

(16) *A peha dee kou na antee batana bono peho saavun koopu.*
One load consists of ten *koopu* bamboos.

(17) *Kavara vai, eara dee voosu vo vaan.*
After that we carry (them) home to the village.

(18) *Ei vaan to kahi paku pete raara o hum vaa tea kopakopaa a koopu.*
It is here in the village where we do the next part (of work), the lengthwise cutting of the *koopu* bamboos.

(19) *Beara kopakopaa vakavara, eara repaa paku pete o hum vaa tea tasu.*
When we have cut (them) lengthwise, we do the next part of work, the beating (the bamboo strips).

(20) *A tasu ei; beara tasu sirisiri bata rara a koopu, ore tamee teo vuri beara takitakinima batara.*
This beating (means) that we beat and split the *koopu* bamboo strips, so that they are flexible when we are weaving the bamboo wall.

(21) *Tea tasu he eara na tasu rara a koopu bona toraara.*
As for the beating, we beat the *koopu* bamboo strips with an axe.

(22) *Be kavara a kiu vaa tea tasu, eara repaa taatagi o komano koopu –*
When the work of the beating is finished, we prepare the inside of the *koopu* bamboo strips –

(23) *ei eara na taraha vatotobin bata koara amaa nava nae.*
this means, we shave its bars and make the surface even.

(24) *Ei to mene ato vakisi bata ni nana bono koopu teo vuri vaa tea takitakinima.*
This is to prevent the bamboo from getting stuck (at the knots) when the weaving is done.

(25) *Beara taatagi vakavara a koopu, eara nao vai tea kiu vaa tea takitakinima.*
When we have prepared the *koopu* bamboo strips, we proceed with the work of the bamboo-weaving.

(26) *Tea takitakinima he na tei me nana bono buaku o kaku hanana vaa tea paku takinima.*
As for the bamboo-weaving, there are two kinds of patterns of making woven bamboo walls.

(27) *O peho o vavaasun, o meho he o vavaagoroho.*
One is the make-stand-up pattern, the other one the make-asleep pattern.

(a) (b)

Figure 3: (a) *O vavaasun* – The make-stand-up pattern,
(b) *O vavaagoroho* – The make-asleep pattern

(a) (b)

Figure 4: (a) *O vavaasun* – The make-stand-up pattern,
(b) *O vavaagoroho* – The make-asleep pattern

(28) *Teo vavaasun, eara na ipinoo rara a sun hiava bara a tatabonata na inu.*

As for the make-stand-up pattern, we measure the height and the width of the house.

(29) *Eara repaa kurukurus a koopu vai to paa tasu vaevuru ara.*
Then we cut the *koopu* bamboo stripes that we have already beaten (according to the measures).

(30) *Be kavara o hum bona, eara repaa vavaasun nao a koopu, ore no suguna komana teo vagegeana na taboo.*
When this part is finished, we make the *koopu* bamboo strips stand up, until the ends of the wall are reached.

(31) *Eara repaa taneo tea hogohogo ni nao a koopu vaantee tea tatabonata na taboo.*
Then we start pushing the (horizontal) *koopu* bamboo strips (in between the vertical ones), until it is enough for the width of the wall.

(32) *Beara hogo, eara na gae rara a ta kukan, eara repaa hogo tavusu nie.*
When we push them, we lift three (vertical) strips, then we push them (the horizontal ones) through.

(33) *Eara repaa taono a ta meha ta kukan, eara repaa gae vaha bana a ta kukan.*
Then we put three other strips on top, and then we lift three strips again.

(34) *Eara paku bata koa vo nao raen ore poosu komana a taboo.*
We just do it like this until the wall is completely closed.

(35) *Teo vavaagoroho he na vaapeha koana, amaa hogo ae a gae kukan.*
With the make-asleep pattern it is just the same, some pushing and the lifting of three (strips).

(36) *Evehee ei kou eara sa paku haara to ipinoo.*
But now we do not do any measurement.

(37) *Eara na vaagoroho rara a ta kukan ge a ta taonim,*
We lay three or five strips down,

(38) *eara repaa taneo kou tea hogo ae gae, ore suguna komana bea taboo poosu vakavara.*
then we start pushing and lifting (the strips) until the wall is completely closed.

(39) *Ahiki to ipinoo, eikou eara na ponuu kaakoo bata koara a koopu beara hogo vaantee bata naora a taboo.*
There is not any measure, because we just bend and move the bamboo strips along, when we are pushing (them) to the (end of the) wall.

Figure 5: *A inu gorogoroho* – A sleeping house